

Snow on the Roddies

Hornpipe

This musical score is for a piece titled "Snow on the Roddies" in the Hornpipe style. It is written in 2/4 time, as indicated by the time signature at the beginning of the first staff. The score consists of eight staves of music, all written in treble clef. The melody is characterized by a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups of four or six, creating a fast, rhythmic feel. There are several repeat signs (double bar lines with dots) throughout the piece, indicating sections to be played multiple times. A triplet of eighth notes is marked with a "3" above it in the third staff. The piece concludes with a final double bar line and repeat dots at the end of the eighth staff.

*Snow on the Roddies* (from the previous page): The basic idea for this came to me one Sunday afternoon as I was considering the grave of the writer and social reformer James Leatham in the kirkyard of St. Machar's Cathedral in Aberdeen. A bird landed on a rhododendron bush near the stone springing a fine cloud of powdered snow into the winter sunshine, which converted itself in my mind into a glittering spangle of sound; as it turned out the strutting staccato effect meant that the melody line had to be ceaselessly varied within a tight space, and it took a long time to develop the later parts.



*The editor beside the tomb of James Leatham*